JACOB MICHAEL MONTGOMERY

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PROFILE

Jacob Montgomery is Professor of Political Science at Washington University in St. Louis, where he develops advanced statistical and machine learning methods and applies them to the study of political behavior, public opinion, and the societal implications of new technologies. His research appears in leading social science journals (*PNAS*, *APSR*, *AJPS*, *Political Analysis*) and premier computer science venues (NeurIPS, FAccT, IMC). He is the author of more than 40 peer-reviewed articles and conference papers, a recipient of the Warren Miller Prize for best paper in *Political Analysis* and the Emerging Scholar Award from the Society for Political Methodology, and has secured over $1.2 million in external funding from the National Science Foundation and private foundations.

Google Scholar (November 2026): 5,644 total citations · *h*-index: 26 · *i*10-index: 38

EMPLOYMENT

WASHINGTON UNIVERSITY IN ST. LOUIS

2023–	Professor of Political Science
2022–2024	Founding Director, Transdisciplinary Institute in Applied Data Sciences (TRIADS)
2017–2023	Associate Professor of Political Science
2011–2017	Assistant Professor of Political Science

EDUCATION

2011	Ph.D., Political Science, DUKE UNIVERSITY
2009	M.S., Statistical Sciences, DUKE UNIVERSITY
2002	B.A., Mathematical-Economics and Political Science, WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY

RESEARCH EXPERTISE

AI & Computational Social Science · American Politics · Machine Learning & Bayesian Methods · Misinformation & Online Political Communication · Natural Language Processing & Computer Vision · Survey Methods & Adaptive Measurement

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Jeon, Soyeon, Messi H.J. Lee, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Calvin K. Lai. 2026. "From Faces to Politics: Vision-Language Models (Sometimes) Link Visual Demographic Characteristics to Ideological Labels." *Political Analysis* 34 (4): 613–621.

Muraoka, Taishi, Dahjin Kim, Christopher Lucas, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Margit Tavits. 2026. "Speaking Their Language?: Multilingualism in Party Communication Across Democracies." *American Journal of Political Science* 70 (2): 752–767.

Chen, Yehu, Muchen Xi, Jacob M. Montgomery, Joshua Jackson, and Roman Garnett. 2024. "Idiographic Personality Gaussian Process for Psychological Assessment." *NeurIPS 2024*.

Lee, Messi H.J., Jacob M. Montgomery, and Calvin K. Lai. 2024. "Large Language Models Portray Socially Subordinate Groups as More Homogeneous, Consistent with a Bias Observed in Humans." *FAccT 2024*.

Duck-Mayr, JBrandon and Jacob M. Montgomery. 2023. "Ends Against the Middle: Measuring Latent Traits When Opposites Respond the Same Way for Antithetical Reasons." *Political Analysis* 31 (4): 606–625.
Warren Miller Prize, Best Paper in Political Analysis, *Society for Political Methodology.*

Lyons, Benjamin A., Jacob M. Montgomery, Andrew M. Guess, Brendan Nyhan, and Jason Reifler. 2021. "Overconfidence in news judgments is associated with false news susceptibility." *PNAS* 118 (23): e2019527118.

Guess, Andrew M., Michael Lerner, Benjamin Lyons, Jacob M. Montgomery, Brendan Nyhan, Jason Reifler, and Neelanjan Sircar. 2020. "A digital media literacy intervention increases discernment between mainstream and false

news in the United States and India." *PNAS* 117 (27): 15536–15545.

Montgomery, Jacob M., Brendan Nyhan, and Michelle Torres. 2018. "How Conditioning on Post-Treatment Variables Can Ruin Your Experiment and What to Do About It." *American Journal of Political Science* 62 (3): 760–775.

Montgomery, Jacob M. and Santiago Olivella. 2018. "Tree-Based Models for Political Science Data." *American Journal of Political Science* 62 (3): 729–744.

Carlson, David and Jacob M. Montgomery. 2017. "A Pairwise Comparison Framework for Fast, Flexible, and Reliable Human Coding of Political Texts." *American Political Science Review* 111 (4): 835–843.

Nyhan, Brendan and Jacob M. Montgomery. 2015. "Connecting the Candidates: Consultant Networks and the Diffusion of Campaign Strategy in American Congressional Elections." *American Journal of Political Science* 59 (2): 292–308.

Recent & Working Papers

Xu, Haofei, Umar Iqbal, and Jacob M. Montgomery. 2026. "Measuring Google AI Overviews: Activation, Source Quality, Claim Fidelity, and Publisher Impact." *Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Internet Measurement Conference (IMC)*, pp. 529–546.

Kim, Dahjin, Taishi Muraoka, Christopher Lucas, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Margit Tavits. 2026. "Polarization but Not Populism Strengthens the Association Between Presidential Election Results and Emotions." *Political Science Research and Methods* 14 (3): 816–832.

Park, Ju Yeon and Jacob M. Montgomery. 2026. "Toward a Framework for Creating Trustworthy Measures with Supervised Machine Learning for Text." *Political Science Research and Methods* 14 (4): 1252–1268.

Xi, Muchen, Erin L. Rossiter, Joshua Jackson, and Jacob M. Montgomery. "Short, Precise, and Valid: A Computerized Adaptive Approach to Measuring the Big Five." *Under review*.

Edelson, Laura, Damon McCoy, Zhaozhi Li, Debra Zhang, and Jacob M. Montgomery. "What the Public Wants Regulated: User Preferences on Online Political Advertising in Six Policy Domains." *Under review.*

Lai, Ruilin, Christopher Lucas, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Margit Tavits. "Populist Rhetoric Engages but Does Not Persuade: Evidence from 90 Countries and Three Experiments." *In preparation*.

Little, Zion, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Keith Schnakenberg. "Preregistration as Cheap Talk: The Logic and Limits of Self-Enforcing Plans in Scientific Research." *In preparation*.

Selected Grants

2023	Carnegie Foundation. *The Role of International Cooperation in Combating the Populist Threat to Democracies.* ($330,000) PI with Christopher Lucas and Margit Tavits.
2022	National Science Foundation. *Populist Rhetoric on Social Media and Its Effects on Democracies.* ($571,005) PI with Christopher Lucas and Margit Tavits.
2016	National Science Foundation. *Computerized Adaptive Testing for Public Opinion Research.* ($291,644)

Selected Fellowships & Awards

2024	Warren Miller Prize, best paper in *Political Analysis*, Society for Political Methodology.
2020	Emerging Scholar Award, Society for Political Methodology.
2015	Political Ties Award, best published article, Political Networks Section of APSA.

Mentorship & Teaching

Dissertation committee chair or co-chair for 15 PhD students (6 current); committee member for 23 additional students; co-authored with 24 current or former students. Teaches graduate and undergraduate courses in quantitative methods, machine learning, and American politics; recipient of the 2025 Teaching Innovation Showcase Award and the 2026 Graduate and Professional Student Council Outstanding Faculty Award.

Service

Vice President, Society for Political Methodology (current); Program Chair, SPM Annual Meeting (2026); Organizer, SPM Annual Meeting (2022); Section Head, APSA (Political Methodology, 2015; Political Networks, 2017); Grant Review Panelist, NSF. Editorial boards: *American Political Science Review*; *Political Analysis*; *American Journal of Political Science*.